

2. **Target Districts.** D1 Rural; SD-Conservation; low-volume segments otherwise eligible for R-2 Rural Road where traffic volumes and abutting uses do not warrant a full two-lane section.
3. **Character.** A Rural Lane may be gravel or paved. Drainage is by open ditches with no curb, and roadside vegetation is generally preserved. Where the traveled way is 15 ft or narrower, the Rural Lane functions as a two-way single-lane roadway; passing pull-outs sufficient for two vehicles to pass — and for the deployment of fire apparatus — shall be provided at intervals of no more than 300 ft. The Rural Lane gives the Town a conforming designation for the many existing narrow rural ways, including historic two-rod (33 ft) rights-of-way, that cannot meet the full Rural Road section.

L. HIGHWAY COMMERCIAL (R-4)

1. **Description.** A Highway Commercial street/road is an auto-oriented commercial corridor with access management, sidewalks where feasible, and coordination with MaineDOT for the cartway geometry.
2. **Target Districts.** SD-Highway Commercial.
3. **Character.** A Highway Commercial corridor accommodates large commercial buildings with deep front setbacks. The cartway is designed and maintained per MaineDOT standards. The frontage zone, building setbacks, sidewalk where present, and access management (curb cuts, driveway spacing) are governed by this Article and Article 2.
4. **State-aid coordination.** Most R-4 segments are state-aid roads. See Section 12 for the coordination protocol with MaineDOT.

M. RURAL HIGHWAY (R-5)

1. **Description.** A Rural Highway is a high-speed regional corridor through rural and conservation contexts, with deep front setbacks, vegetative screening, and MaineDOT-controlled cartway geometry.
2. **Target Districts.** SD-Rural Highway.
3. **Character.** A Rural Highway preserves the rural character of the corridor by maintaining vegetative screening between the cartway and abutting development, deep front setbacks measured from the centerline, and tightly managed curb-cut spacing.
4. **State-aid coordination.** All R-5 segments are state-aid roads. See Section 12 for the coordination protocol with MaineDOT.

N. DRIVEWAY (D)

1. **Description.** A Driveway is a private vehicular access way from a Street or Road to the interior of a single lot, including access to homes, parking lots, or loading docks. A Driveway is not a Street or Road and is not subject to the construction specifications of Section 11.
2. **Applicability.** A Driveway provides access to no more than two single family dwellings or one two-family dwelling on a single lot, except where a shared driveway is authorized under Section 7.B.
3. **Calibration.** Driveway standards in Section 7 are calibrated by the District in which the driveway is located.

3. TYPE STANDARDS TABLE

A. PURPOSE

1. To provide, in a single table, the dimensional and qualitative standards for each Street and Road Type.

B. APPLICABILITY

1. The standards in this Section apply to the design and construction of new streets and roads under Section 6, and to the modification of existing streets and roads under Section 14.

2. Sight distance standards (Section 8) and construction specifications (Section 11) are referenced from the Type Standards Table but defined in their respective sections.

C. GENERAL

1. Each Street Type is described by the standards in Table 3.1a (Street Type Standards), and each Road Type by the standards in Table 3.1b (Road Type Standards).
2. Where a range is given (e.g., "10–11 ft"), the value selected within the range must be supported by an engineering justification submitted with the application.
3. Where "per MaineDOT" is indicated, the Maine Department of Transportation's current geometric design standards for the applicable functional classification apply to the cartway. The Town retains authority over the frontage zone, building setbacks, sidewalks, and access management as set forth in this Article and in Article 2.
4. All measurements in this Section are minimums unless otherwise indicated.

D. BASIS FOR RIGHT-OF-WAY WIDTHS

1. The right-of-way widths in Table 3.1a and Table 3.1b are calibrated to the cross-section each Type is expected to carry — traveled way, on-street parking, planting strips, sidewalks, shoulders, and drainage — together with a margin for snow storage, dry utilities, and grading. They are not a single uniform width applied without regard to context.
2. The widths remain rooted in the traditional New England rod (1 rod = 16.5 ft): a Main Street (S-1) at 66 ft is four rods, the historic town-road width of 49.5 ft is three rods, and a Rural Lane (R-3) and other narrow ways descend to the two-rod (33 ft) minimum. The ranges in this Section allow a Type to default to less than the historic three-rod width where its cross-section does not require it.
3. No Maine statute prescribes a minimum right-of-way width. 30-A M.R.S.A. §4404 requires only that a subdivision not cause unreasonable highway or public-road congestion or unsafe conditions. These widths are set under the Town's home-rule authority (Section 1.C), and the safety-critical dimensions — traveled way width, sight distance (Section 8), and intersection geometry (Section 9) — are fixed independently of the right-of-way range.

4. These widths implement the policies of the Comprehensive Plan, which concerning village and rural character, walkability, and the efficient use of land and public investment (Draft to insert the specific Comprehensive Plan policy citations here.) "ded development goals" (Streets & Roads: Road Standards = Land Use Goals, p. 46). The calibrated rights-of-way further the

4. OWNERSHIP CATEGORIES

the Town's exposure to future road costs (Less road, p. 43). Its observation that allowing

A. PURPOSE Streets to become narrower ... slows traffic and increases

1. To distinguish the form and character of a street or road, regulated as a walkable, pedestrian-scaled Main Street and village center (Main Street, pp. 13–14) and for the protection of rural character (Natural & Built Landscape, p. 116).
2. To recognize the four ownership categories that exist under Maine law and

Town practice, and to acknowledge that any Street or Road Type may, in

4. OWNERSHIP CATEGORIES

principle, exist under any of these categories.

A. PURPOSE

B. APPLICABILITY

1. To distinguish the form and character of a street or road, regulated as a

Every street and road within the Town of Newcastle is assigned, in addition

to its Type, one Ownership Category from this Section.

The Ownership Category of a street or road is recorded on the District Map

alongside its Type.

To recognize the four ownership categories that exist under Maine law and

Town practice, and to acknowledge that any Street or Road Type may, in

principle, exist under any of these categories.

D2. Where the standards of this Article

1. The type of a street or road describes its form, character, and design standards. The Ownership Category describes its statutory ownership and management status. The two designations are independent: a Main Street with a Public Easement instrument — the provisions of Section 12 (Coordination with MaineDOT) and Section 4.E (below) apply.

- ### E. PROCESS FOR CHANGING OWNERSHIP

2. Where the standards of this Article conflict with the standards or practices

1. The acceptance of a Private Road or Public Easement as a Town Way is a Town Meeting matter and is processed under Article 8 §20 Land Conveyance instrument – the provisions of Section 12 (Coordination)
2. Discontinuance of a Town Way is processed under 23 MRSA §3026-A and Article 8 §27 Planning Board.

3. Changes in Ownership Category do not by themselves

1. The acceptance of a Private Road or Public Easement as a Town Way is a street or road. The Type is set under Section 5 or Section 6 and is reviewed only under Section 14.B (Reclassification).

5. CLASSIFICATION OF EXISTING STREETS

2. Discontinuance of a Town Way is processed under 23 M.R.S.A. §5026-A and reviewed by the Planning Board.
3. Changes in Ownership Category do not by themselves change the Type of a

A. PURPOSE The Type is set under Section 5 or Section 6 and is reviewed only under Section 14.B (Reclassification).

1. To assign, at adoption of this Article, a Type and an Ownership Category to every existing street and road within the Town of Newcastle.

TABLE 31. STREET TYPE STANDARDS

Pavement specification

Right-of-Way width

Pavement specification